

Unit - 4 : Curriculum Vitae and Resume

4.1 Curriculum Vitae and Resume : Overview

Meaning

A Curriculum Vitae (CV) and a Resume are important documents used while applying for a job, internship or higher studies. They provide a summary of our personal details, educational qualifications, skills, achievements and work experience. These documents help the employer to understand our background and judge whether we are suitable for the position or not. A well-written CV or Resume creates a good first impression and increases the chance of getting an interview. Both should be clear, concise, well-organized and free from errors.

Curriculum Vitae (CV)

Curriculum Vitae is a detailed document that provides a complete overview of a person's life, including education, work experience, skills, achievements, publications, projects and other relevant information. It is usually longer than a resume and is commonly used for academic, research or professional positions, especially in higher education.

Resume

A Resume is a brief and focused document that highlights the most relevant information about a person's education, skills, work experience and achievements. It is usually one to two pages long and is used mainly for job applications in the corporate sector. A resume is tailored to a specific job, so that the most important and relevant details are presented to the employer in a clear and attractive manner.

Key Differences between CV and Resume

Basis	Curriculum Vitae (CV)	Resume
Length	Detailed and longer	Short and concise
Purpose	Used for academic/research positions	Used for job applications
Content	Complete information	Only relevant information
Focus	Overall career history	Specific to the job
Format	Can be multiple pages	Usually 1-2 pages

Purpose :

- Show your profile
- Highlight your skills
- Create a positive impression
- Helps in career growth

"A good CV opens doors to new opportunities."

CURRICULUM VITAE



Name : _____
 Education : _____
 Experience : _____
 Skills : _____
 Achievements : _____

RESUME



Name : _____
 Contact : _____
 Education : _____
 Skills : _____
 Experience : _____

Points to Remember :

- Use a clean and professional format.
- Keep the information accurate.
- Highlight your strengths and achievements.
- Avoid unnecessary or irrelevant details.
- Use proper grammar and simple language.
- Customize your resume for each job.
- Always proofread before submitting.

"Your CV is your story, make it worth reading."

4.2 Types of CV

There are different types of CV, each designed for a specific purpose and career stage. The type of CV you choose depends on your experience, skills, education and the job you are applying for. A well-chosen CV helps you present your strengths in the best possible way and increases your chances of getting selected.

"Choose the right type, Show your best self."

Main Types of CV

1. **Chronological CV** - This is the most common type of CV. It lists your education, work experience and achievements in reverse chronological order (latest first). It is suitable for candidates with a stable work history.
2. **Functional CV** - This type of CV focuses on your skills, abilities and achievements rather than your work history. It is useful for freshers or those with gaps in their careers.
3. **Combination (Hybrid) CV** - It combines both chronological and functional formats. It highlights your skills as well as your work experience. It is suitable for experienced professionals.
4. **Targeted CV** - This CV is customized for a specific job or industry. It includes relevant skills and experience that match the job requirements.
5. **Academic CV** - Used mainly for academic, research or teaching positions. It includes detailed information about education, research work, publications, seminars and academic achievements.

Quick Comparison

- Chronological → Work history first
- Functional → Skills based
- Combination → Skills + Experience
- Targeted → For a specific job
- Academic → For academic and research field



Different CVs for Different Goals."

4.3 Covering Letter

Meaning

A covering letter (also called a cover letter) is a formal letter sent along with your CV or resume when applying for a job. Its main purpose is to introduce yourself, explain why you are interested in the position and highlight your relevant skills and experience. It gives you an opportunity to make a positive first impression and persuade the employer to read your CV.

Key Points :

- Keep it short (1 page)
- Use formal language
- Mention the job title
- Show enthusiasm
- Highlight key skills
- End with a polite closing

Format of a Covering Letter

1. Sender's Address (Your address)
2. Date
3. Receiver's Address (Employer's name, designation, company)
4. Subject (e.g. Application for the post of _____)
5. Salutation (Dear Sir/Madam)
6. Introduction (mention the position and source)
7. Body (highlight your skills, experience and suitability)
8. Closing (express gratitude and request for an interview)
9. Complimentary Close (Yours faithfully / Yours sincerely)
10. Signature and Name

Sample Covering Letter

Rohit Sharma
123, Green Park
Kanpur - 208001
25 August 2025
The Hiring Manager
XYZ Technologies Pvt. Ltd.
Kanpur

Subject : Application for the Post of Web Developer

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to apply for the position of Web Developer as advertised on your company website. I have completed my PGDCA and have good knowledge of HTML, CSS, JavaScript and other web technologies. I am eager to contribute my skills to your organization and learn new things.

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to the opportunity for an interview.

Yours sincerely,
(Rohit Sharma)

4.4 Resume

Meaning

A resume is a short, well-organized document that provides a summary of your education, skills, work experience, achievements and other relevant information. It is usually one or two pages long and is used while applying for a job. A good resume helps you create a positive first impression and increases your chances of getting selected for an interview. It should be clear, concise, error-free and tailored to the specific job you are applying for.

"A great resume doesn't just list your experience, it shows your potential."

Key Point :

- Keep it short
- Be honest
- Highlight achievements
- Use clear format
- Tailor it for each job

Importance of a Resume

- **Creates first impression** - Your resume is the first thing an employer sees.
- **Showcases your skills** - Highlights your key skills and strengths.
- **Helps in shortlisting** - A well-written resume increases your chances of getting an interview.
- **Professional growth** - Helps you present your career goals clearly.
- **Useful for multiple opportunities** - Can be used for job, internship or higher studies.



Right Resume
Brighter
Future !

Types of Resume

1. **Chronological Resume** - This is the most common type. It lists your work experience in reverse chronological order (latest first). It is suitable for candidates with a strong and consistent work history.
2. **Functional Resume** - This type focuses on your skills and abilities rather than work history. It is useful for freshers, career changers or those with gaps in their employment.
3. **Combination (Hybrid) Resume** - It combines both chronological and functional formats. It highlights your skills as well as work experience.
4. **Targeted Resume** - This resume is customized for a specific job or industry. It focuses on the most relevant skills and experiences.
5. **Academic Resume** - Used mainly for academic, research or teaching positions. It includes detailed information about education, research work, publications, seminars and academic achievements.

Types of Resume (Visual)

Chronological
Resume

Functional
Resume

Combination
Resume

Targeted
Resume

Academic
Resume

"Different goals
Different resumes
Same success !"

Tips for Writing an Effective Resume

- Keep it short and simple (1-2 pages).
- Use a clean and professional format.
- Include only relevant information.
- Highlight your key skills and achievements.
- Use action verbs (e.g., developed, managed, created).
- Avoid grammatical errors and spelling mistakes.
- Customize your resume for each job application.
- Use clear headings and bullet points.

Common Sections in a Resume

1. Personal Information (Name, Contact, Address)
2. Career Objective
3. Educational Qualifications
4. Work Experience (if any)
5. Skills
6. Achievements / Certifications
7. Projects (if any)
8. Hobbies / Interests (optional)
9. References (optional)

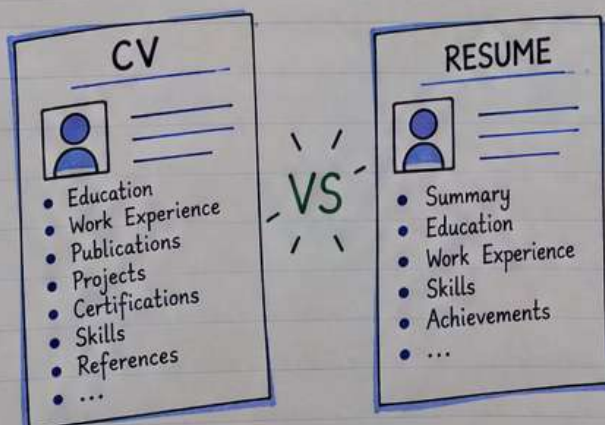
4.5 Difference between CV and Resume

Introduction

Both Curriculum Vitae (CV) and Resume are important documents used while applying for a job, internship or higher studies. They provide information about your education, skills, work experience and achievements. Although the terms CV and Resume are often used interchangeably, there are significant differences between them in terms of length, purpose, content and usage. Understanding these differences helps you choose the right document for the right opportunity.

"Same goal
Different format
Know the
difference!"

Basis	Curriculum Vitae (CV)	Resume
Full Form	Curriculum Vitae (Latin for "course of life")	Resume (French word meaning "summary")
Length	Longer (2 or more pages)	Shorter (1-2 pages)
Purpose	Provides a complete overview of your academic and professional life.	Provides a brief and targeted summary of your skills and experience.
Content	Detailed information including education, work experience, research, publications, projects, certifications, etc.	Only relevant and most important information related to the job.
Focus	Comprehensive, covers entire career history.	Focused, customized for a specific job.
Usage	Used mainly for academic, research, teaching or higher education positions.	Used mainly for job applications in corporate and private sectors.
Format	Can be multiple pages, detailed and chronological.	Usually 1-2 pages, concise and well-structured.
Customization	Generally not customized for each application.	Tailored for each job based on the requirements.
Level of Detail	Includes complete information, even older achievements.	Includes only recent and relevant information.
Common Sections	Personal details, education, work experience, research, publications, projects, skills, awards, references, etc.	Personal details, summary or objective, education, work experience, skills, achievements, etc.
Used In	Academia, research institutions, NGOs, higher studies (MS/PhD), government jobs (sometimes).	Private companies, startups, internships and most job applications.



Key Takeaways :

1. CV is detailed; Resume is concise.
2. CV is used for academic and research roles; Resume is used for most job applications.
3. CV covers your complete career; Resume highlights only relevant information.
4. Always choose the document according to the purpose and job requirements.